(ii) Shortcut method (or) Step deviation method

To make the calculation simple, we provide the following formula. Let A be the assumed mean, x_i be the middle value of the ith class and c is the width of the class interval.

$$d_i = \frac{x_i - A}{c}$$

$$\sigma = c \times \sqrt{\frac{\Sigma f_i d_i^2}{N} - \left(\frac{\Sigma f_i d_i}{N}\right)^2}$$

Example 8.13 Marks of the students in a particular subject of a class are given below. Find its standard deviation.

Marks	0-10	10-20	20-30	30-40	40-50	50-60	60-70
Number of students	8	12	17	14	9	7	4

Solution Let the assumed mean, $A = 35$, $c = 10$

Marks	Mid value (x_i)	f_i	$d_i = x_i - A$	$d_i = \frac{x_i - A}{c}$	$f_i d_i$	$f_i d_i^2$
0-10	5	8	-30	−3	−24	72
10-20	15	12	-20	−2	−24	48
20-30	25	17	-10	−1	−17	17
30-40	35	14	0	0	0	0
40-50	45	9	10	1	9	9
50-60	55	7	20	2	14	28
60-70	65	4	30	3	12	36
		$N = 71$			$\Sigma f_i d_i = -30$	$\Sigma f_i d_i^2 = 210$

Standard deviation $\sigma = c \times \sqrt{\frac{\Sigma f_i d_i^2}{N} - \left(\frac{\Sigma f_i d_i}{N}\right)^2}$

$$\sigma = 10 \times \sqrt{\frac{210}{71} - \left(-\frac{30}{71}\right)^2} = 10 \times \sqrt{\frac{210}{71} - \frac{900}{5041}}$$

$$= 10 \times \sqrt{2.779} \; ; \quad \sigma \simeq 16.67$$

Thinking Corner

1. The standard deviation of a data is 2.8, if 5 is added to all the data values then the new standard deviation is ___.
2. If S is the standard deviation of values p, q, r then standard deviation of $p-3$, $q-3$, $r-3$ is ___.

Example 8.14 The mean and standard deviation of 15 observations are found to be 10 and 5 respectively. On rechecking it was found that one of the observation with value 8 was incorrect. Calculate the correct mean and standard deviation if the correct observation value was 23?

Solution $n = 15$, $\bar{x} = 10$, $\sigma = 5$; $\bar{x} = \frac{\Sigma x}{n}$; $\Sigma x = 15 \times 10 = 150$

Wrong observation value $= 8$, Correct observation value $= 23$.

Correct total $= 150 - 8 + 23 = 165$

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